

DEGREE & GRADUATION REQUIREMENTS

Purpose:

To establish a policy governing the graduation requirements and criteria for obtaining a degree at Bucknell University.

Scope:

This policy applies to all currently enrolled students

Definitions:

"Candidate" means a student currently enrolled at the University and in the process of meeting final requirements for a degree.

"In-residence" means credits earned at Bucknell University.

Policy:

Quantitative Requirements

- A. Every Candidate for the following degrees must earn at least 32 credits
 - 1. Bachelor of Arts,
 - 2. Bachelor of Science,
 - 3. Bachelor of Science in Business Administration,
 - 4. Bachelor of Science in Education, or
 - 5. Bachelor of Music.
- B. Every Candidate for a degree in the College of Engineering must earn at least 34 credits.
- C. Every Candidate for the combination degree of Bachelor of Science in one of the branches of engineering and Bachelor of Arts must earn at least 42 credits.

Curricular Requirements

- A. Every Candidate for any undergraduate degree must complete the curricular requirements as specified for the degree, including:
 - 1. major requirements,
 - 2. major related requirements,
 - 3. general education requirements (i.e., the provisions of the College Core Curriculum for students in the College of Arts & Sciences and the Freeman College of Management), and
 - 4. the University writing requirement.

- B. Substitution for or waiver of any requirement must be approved in advance by the dean of the student's college.

Degrees and Majors

- A. Student's may only receive one undergraduate degree from Bucknell at a time; that is, each degree requires the fulfillment of all curricular requirements and the full course credits as noted above.
- B. It is possible to formally declare a second major, even if that major is from another degree program.
 - 1. If declared, the pursuit and successful completion of the second major, even if from another degree program, will be noted on the student's academic record (transcript).
 - 2. If the two majors are in different degree programs, the student may choose which degree to receive, but may receive only one degree.

Double Counting Courses Toward Requirements

- A. Courses that fulfill general education requirements in any college may also be used to fulfill major or minor curricular requirements.
- B. Courses may not be counted in more than one major or minor; when one major or minor course satisfies the requirement in another major or minor, it must be replaced by an elective in the second major or minor. Major related requirements may be counted toward another major or minor.

Receiving a Second Degree

- A. Typically, only one undergraduate degree may be received. However, students who have received one baccalaureate degree, whether at Bucknell University or elsewhere, may seek a subsequent, second baccalaureate degree in a different curriculum by applying to the dean of admissions; acceptance requires the approval of the dean of the college and the dean of admissions. Inquiries regarding second-degree admission should be directed to the Office of Admissions.
- B. To be accepted as a Candidate for a second baccalaureate degree, the new program must be fundamentally different from the first and must be judged by the University to be educationally necessary.
- C. The second degree program must require at least two years of academic work (16 course credits).
 - 1. All requirements for the second degree, including the major and general education requirements, must be fulfilled if the appropriate courses were not taken previously.
 - 2. Coursework for the second degree must include the number of courses required by the major (which may include electives in the major if some of the requirements were taken previously).

3. All additional course credits must be taken In-residence.
- D. Second-degree applicants must follow the transfer application process described under Admissions Information in the current University *course catalog*.
- E. Bucknell aid is not available for second degree students, but eligibility may remain for federal loans if the maximum has not already been borrowed.

Grade Point Average Requirements

- A. Candidates for a bachelor's degree must have a cumulative grade point average of at least 2.00.
- B. Candidates for an engineering degree or for the combination degree of Bachelor of Science in one of the branches of engineering and Bachelor of Arts must have a cumulative grade point average of at least 2.00 for all courses in the College of Engineering.

Disciplinary Withholding of Degree

The conferring of an academic degree may be postponed as a disciplinary outcome if the following criteria are met:

- A. The Respondent is a senior who would otherwise meet the criteria to graduate.
- B. The outcome of probation, deferred suspension or suspension might otherwise be imposed.

A Student may be permitted to remain on campus to complete the academic requirements for their degree but conferral of the degree will be postponed until no earlier than the next regularly scheduled commencement exercise after the one in which the student would have participated and may be withheld permanently in extraordinary cases.

Revocation of Degree

The University President may recommend the revocation of an awarded degree to the Board of Trustees if the following criteria are met:

- A. The Respondent has already been awarded a Bucknell degree; and,
- B. The status of expulsion or suspension might otherwise be imposed for alleged misconduct; and,
- C. The information leading to the allegation did not come to light until after the conferring of the degree, but the misconduct occurred before the degree was conferred.

Only the Board of Trustees may revoke a degree in accordance with a process established by action of the Board of Trustees. If the Board of Trustees does not uphold the outcome of revocation, the case against the Student will be considered dismissed.